

Shashi Shekhar

Credit Risk Strategy

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Credit risk strategist with 5+ years in lending analytics, currently in Global Credit Risk at PayPal on a \$2B+ business lending book. I design underwriting rules, default definitions and loan-level profitability models, and take them from analysis to the production rule engine. Designed the underwriting rules behind a UK Open Banking business-loan launch.

SKILLS

Credit strategy: Underwriting policy and rule-engine design, PD calibration, champion-challenger testing, vintage loss (VLR) analysis, multi-horizon default definition, pricing and line assignment, loan-level P&L (CLTV), Open Banking underwriting, IFRS 9 PD/EAD/LGD, collections early warning

Modelling: Gradient boosting (XGBoost, LightGBM), scorecards, CART, survival analysis (Cox PH), SHAP

Data and tools: Python, SQL, R, PySpark, AWS, Snowflake, Tableau, Power BI

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Data Scientist, Global Credit Risk

PayPal, Bengaluru | Nov 2024 – Present

- Designed the approve/decline underwriting rules for a **UK Open Banking business-loan launch**; the production rule engine adopted them **unchanged**.
- Designed a **multi-horizon default definition** after showing that a single early delinquency indicator was statistically insufficient; validated by champion-challenger with population stability monitoring; adopted as the production rule layer, cutting vintage loss rate by **2.5%** with a **realised profit uplift**.
- Redesigned US eligibility rules using commercial bureau data and PD calibration: **3% uplift** in post-bureau eligibility. Report early-delinquency and guardrail metrics to the credit risk committee.
- Designed a bank-based underwriting decision engine: consolidated redundant legacy rules and combined internal PD models with external bureau scores across bureau, Open Banking and no-document paths, all resolving to **pricing and line assignment**.
- Launched Open Banking underwriting for US business loans and eliminated data-extraction failures within weeks of launch.
- Built a **60-month lifetime-value (CLTV) model** for a lending book across 30 score-band and customer-type segments, showing which segments **earn back their acquisition cost** at 2 and 5 years; used to set score-band cut-offs and for pricing and acquisition decisions.
- Direct **2 external consultant data scientists**.

Senior Manager, Analytics – Risk & Data Science

Liquiloans, Mumbai | Feb 2024 – Oct 2024

- Led a **team of 5** (3 full-time, 2 interns) across scorecards, collections and credit strategy.
- Built application, behaviour and propensity scorecards (gradient boosting, SHAP): **10% uplift in approval rate** and **0.5% reduction in NPA**.
- Built the early-warning system used by collections and credit teams, raising **collection efficiency 30%**; developed cross-sell and partnership credit strategies from loss forecasting (IFRS 9 PD/EAD/LGD).

Business Analyst – Strategy, Growth & Risk

Jodo, Bengaluru | Oct 2022 – Dec 2023

- Built the **company's first in-house credit risk model**, from zero: **40% faster underwriting turnaround** and a newly identified customer segment. Managed 2 interns.
- Built the AWS data warehouse pipeline (Glue, PySpark), cutting data turnaround 40× and automating 80% of ad-hoc reporting.

Data Analyst – Data Science Consulting

Accelera Eloquent, New Delhi | Jan 2021 – Oct 2022

- Built segmentation and NLP models for retail and eCommerce clients (footfall +30%); a Bayesian A/B testing framework lifted new-product sales 10%.

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Electronics & Communication Engineering

IIIT Guwahati, India | 2019